

Juan C. Yamin

Department of Economics, Brown University

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2026–27 Economics Job Market Candidate

Fields: Econometrics, Development Economics
Research interests: Statistical decision theory, experimental design, causal inference
Placement Director: Toru Kitagawa | toru_kitagawa@brown.edu
Placement Manager: Angelica Spertini | angelica_spertini@brown.edu | 401-863-2465

DISSERTATION COMMITTEE AND REFERENCES

Toru Kitagawa Professor of Economics Brown University toru_kitagawa@brown.edu	Soonwoo Kwon Assistant Professor of Economics Brown University soonwoo_kwon@brown.edu	Jonathan Roth Professor of Economics Brown University jonathan_roth@brown.edu
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EDUCATION

Brown University , Providence, RI	
Ph.D. in Economics	Expected May 2027
M.A. in Economics	May 2022
Universidad de los Andes , Bogotá, Colombia	
M.Sc. in Economics	March 2019
B.Sc. in Economics	October 2017

JOB MARKET PAPER

Poverty Targeting with Imperfect Information

How should antipoverty programs allocate transfers when household income is known only through noisy predictions? I formulate this as a statistical decision problem in which a policymaker chooses nonnegative transfers within a fixed budget to minimize squared deviations of post-transfer income from the poverty line. I show that the standard plug-in rule, which treats predictions as exact, is inadmissible. I then develop a nonparametric empirical Bayes allocation rule that replaces the estimated gaps with posterior mean poverty gaps. The rule's Bayes regret vanishes at least as fast as the mean squared error in estimating posterior mean poverty gaps, despite the budget and nonnegativity constraints. The approach extends, with weaker guarantees, to a policymaker who cares only about how far households remain below the poverty line after transfers and to programs that pay a fixed set of benefit amounts. In simulations using household surveys from nine African countries, the empirical Bayes rule reaches about 1.8 times as many poor people as plug-in OLS with the same budget. It achieves the same average poverty gap reduction with 6.1% less spending or a 42% smaller training sample.

OTHER WORKING PAPERS

When and How to Pilot: Design Rules for Two-Wave Experiments

Two-Way Effects Models: A Nonparametric Empirical Bayes Approach
with Cole Davis

Draft available upon request

PUBLICATIONS

Birds of a Feather Collude Together: Subnational Alignment and Corruption

with Leopoldo Fergusson, Arturo Harker, and Carlos Molina
Forthcoming in the American Political Science Review

SOFTWARE

cmrdesign (R and Python)

[Documentation](#) | [Code](#) | [CRAN](#) | [PyPI](#)

Uses pilot data to choose main-wave treatment and control sample shares and report a finite-sample regret certificate. Supports two-arm, multi-arm, and stratified experiments.

RESEARCH AND INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Brown University, Department of Economics

June 2023–Jan. 2026

Research Assistant to Soonwoo Kwon, Providence, RI

Conducted simulations and empirical applications on fixed-effect shrinkage, regression discontinuity, and bias-aware inference in regularized regression.

Amazon, Delivery Experience

May–Aug. 2025

Economist Intern, Bellevue, WA

Evaluated a nationwide delivery-speed program using difference-in-differences and shift-share IV to estimate direct and geographic spillover effects.

Universidad de los Andes, Department of Economics

Aug. 2017–July 2021

Research Assistant to Leopoldo Fergusson and James A. Robinson, Bogotá, Colombia

Built datasets and implemented instrumental-variables, regression-discontinuity, and panel-data methods to study conflict, corruption, and state capacity.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE@MIT), Cambridge 2026

When and How to Pilot: Design Rules for Two-Wave Experiments (accepted for presentation)

Midwest Econometrics Group Annual Meeting, Cincinnati 2026

Poverty Targeting with Imperfect Information (accepted for presentation)

World Congress of the Econometric Society, Seoul 2025

Poverty Targeting with Imperfect Information

Advances with Field Experiments, Chicago 2025

When and How to Pilot: Design Rules for Two-Wave Experiments

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Merit Dissertation Fellowship, Department of Economics, Brown University Fall 2026

International Travel Fund, Graduate School, Brown University 2025

Conference Travel Fund, Graduate School, Brown University 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Brown University, Teaching Assistant

Applied Econometrics II (Ph.D.), Peter Hull Spring 2026

Applied Econometrics I (Ph.D.), Toru Kitagawa Fall 2024

Using Big Data to Solve Economic and Social Problems (undergraduate), John N. Friedman Fall 2022 and 2023

Universidad de los Andes, Teaching Assistant

Aug. 2018–June 2020

Advanced Econometrics (graduate), Raquel Bernal

Political Underpinnings of Prosperity and Poverty (graduate), James A. Robinson

Thinking Problems (undergraduate), Tomás Rodríguez

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Organizer, Brown Metrics Coffee 2024–26

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Tools: R, Python, Stata, MATLAB, SQL, Git, LaTeX

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)